POSTERIOR CONES AND SHARP RECONSTRUCTION THRESHOLDS ON FINITE-MEAN GALTON–WATSON TREES

YITZCHAK SHMALO

Abstract. We study reconstruction for symmetric ferromagnetic Potts broadcasting on an observed Galton–Watson tree with arbitrary finite mean offspring. For three states we construct an explicit invariant condition on posterior laws using the polynomial $H = y - x^2/2$, where x and y are the quadratic and cubic centered posterior invariants. Two global inequalities, certified by exact nonnegative coefficients, preserve this condition and give strict information contraction. Combining the resulting argument with an existing four-state posterior cone proves that reconstruction occurs exactly when $d\lambda^2 > 1$ for both three and four states, including nonreconstruction at equality. No offspring variance or tail assumption is required. We give explicit critical decay bounds, a first-moment-only supercritical argument, and almost-sure statements conditional on survival. Exact verification programs and complete coefficient tables accompany the proof. The noiseless unary-line endpoint is classified separately.

1. Introduction and main result

The reconstruction problem asks whether a noisy broadcast retains information about its root at arbitrarily large distances. For the symmetric q-state channel

$$K_\lambda(i,j) = \lambda \mathbf{1}_{\{i=j\}} + \frac{1-\lambda}{q}, \qquad i,j \in \{1,\dots,q\}, \tag{1}$$

the Kesten–Stigum parameter on a tree of mean offspring d is $d\lambda^2$. Reconstruction above this parameter's unit threshold follows from a second-moment argument [8, 11]. The difficult direction is to rule out nonlinear reconstruction at and below the threshold.

For two states the bound is sharp: Bleher, Ruiz and Zagrebnov [1] treat regular trees, Evans, Kenyon, Peres and Schulman [3] general trees, with d replaced by the branching number, and Pemantle and Peres [13] the critical Ising model on trees. Other channels can be reconstructed below the bound [10], while robust reconstruction is determined by it [7]. Non-reconstruction criteria below the bound that hold on Galton–Watson trees are given in [11, 5, 6]. Mézard and Montanari [9] predicted from numerical evidence that for the ferromagnetic Potts channel the bound is sharp when $q \le 4$ and not when $q \ge 5$; see also [2, 14]. Formentin and Külske [4, Conjecture 2.13] conjecture that for $q \le 4$ there is almost surely no reconstruction on a Galton–Watson tree with mean offspring d when $d\lambda^2 < 1$.

Sly proved sharpness for the three-state model at sufficiently large regular degree and non-sharpness for every regular degree when $q \ge 5$ [17]. Mossel, Sly and Sohn [12] prove non-reconstruction below the bound for three and four states on Galton–Watson trees whose mean offspring is sufficiently large, and non-sharpness for $q \ge 5$. The three-state case on every regular tree and the four-state case on the binary tree are treated in [15, 16]. More recent manuscripts establish the three-state symmetric and four-state ferromagnetic thresholds on all regular and observed Poisson trees [18, 19]. The positive-channel argument in the three-state manuscript uses

Date: 24 October 2026.

Key words and phrases. Reconstruction on trees, Potts model, Kesten–Stigum threshold, Galton–Watson process, posterior experiments, exact polynomial certificates.

offspring-specific entropy estimates, whereas the four-state manuscript supplies a cone of posterior laws stable under pairwise products.

This paper gives a simple three-state cone with global exact certificates and develops the finite-mean Galton–Watson consequences for both three and four states. The three-state certificate is self-contained below and in Appendix A. The four-state invariant and its pair inequalities are those of [19]. Combining these two cones yields a unified proof for arbitrary finite-mean offspring distributions, with explicit decay estimates at the critical threshold. For the ferromagnetic channel, Theorem 1.1 proves the three- and four-state cases of the conjecture of Formentin and Külske, including the equality case $d\lambda^2 = 1$.

Let D be a nonnegative integer-valued random variable with finite mean d, and let T be a Galton–Watson tree with iid offspring D. The tree is independent of the spin process. The root spin σ_ρ is uniform on $\{1, \dots, q\}$; conditional on a parent spin, its children are generated independently through (1). The observer knows T and the spins on level $L_n(T)$. Put

$$p_n = \mathbb{P}(\sigma_\rho = \cdot \mid T, \sigma_{L_n(T)}), \qquad a_n(T) = \mathbb{E}_\sigma[\mathrm{TV}(p_n, u_q) \mid T], \qquad a_n = \mathbb{E}_T a_n(T), \tag{2}$$

where $u_q = (1/q, \dots, 1/q)$. Reconstruction means that the corresponding limiting advantage is positive. For a fixed locally finite tree, $a_n(T)$ is nonincreasing by data processing, so this limit exists.

Theorem 1.1 (Finite-mean reconstruction threshold)**.** *Let $q \in \{3, 4\}$ and $0 < \lambda < 1$. For symmetric Potts broadcasting on the observed Galton–Watson tree described above:*

(1) If $d\lambda^2 \le 1$, then $a_n(T) \to 0$ for almost every tree.
(2) If $d\lambda^2 > 1$, then $\lim_n a_n(T) > 0$ for almost every surviving tree, and the limit is zero on extinction. In particular $\lim_n a_n > 0$.

Thus annealed reconstruction occurs if and only if $d\lambda^2 > 1$. The result requires only $\mathbb{E}D < \infty$ and includes every regular d-ary tree with integer $d \ge 2$.

The exclusion of $\lambda = 1$ from the finite-noise theorem is substantive only at the deterministic unary tree: $D \equiv 1, \lambda = 1$ reconstructs perfectly although $d\lambda^2 = 1$. At $\lambda = 1$ and $d > 1$ reconstruction is perfect on survival; nondegenerate critical and subcritical Galton–Watson trees become extinct almost surely. The case $\lambda = 0$ is immediate. All results here concern the ferromagnetic regime; no antiferromagnetic conclusion is obtained by the cone argument.

2. Posterior experiments and Bayes products

An experiment with uniform input $X \in \{1, \dots, q\}$ induces a marginal law μ of the posterior vector $p = \mathbb{P}(X = \cdot \mid Y)$ in the simplex Δ_q. Its barycenter is u_q. We call the law symmetric if it is invariant under every permutation of the input labels.

Lemma 2.1 (Bayes product)**.** *Suppose two experiments are independent conditional on the common uniform input, and their marginal posterior laws are μ and ν. For independent $p \sim \mu$ and $r \sim \nu$, define*

$$U_i = q p_i r_i, \qquad z = \sum_i U_i, \qquad P_i = U_i / z \quad (z > 0).$$

For every bounded measurable f,

$$\mathbb{E}_{\mu \star \nu} f(P) = \mathbb{E}_{\mu \otimes \nu}[z f(P)], \tag{3}$$

with zero contribution when $z = 0$. If the laws are symmetric and f is permutation invariant, the integrand may be averaged over every relative permutation of r.

Proof. With respect to each observation's marginal law, its density conditional on $X = i$ is qp_i or qr_i. Conditional independence gives joint marginal density $\frac{1}{q}\sum_i (qp_i)(qr_i) = z$ relative to the product of the two marginals. Bayes' formula gives the displayed posterior and (3). The marginal posterior barycenters imply $\mathbb{E}z = 1$. If a normalizer is zero, that pair has zero probability under the joint observation law. Symmetry permits averaging the second marginal over relative permutations without changing its distribution. □

It is essential that independence in (3) is under the reference product measure. The actual joint observation measure contains the factor z.

Lemma 2.2 (Edges, mixtures, and additional observations)**.** *The following operations on posterior experiments have the stated properties.*

(1) Passing a child experiment through one channel edge maps its posterior to

$$p \longmapsto u_q + \lambda(p - u_q). \tag{4}$$

(2) An observed mixing label independent of the input mixes the corresponding posterior laws.

(3) If Φ is convex on Δ_q, observing additional information cannot decrease $\mathbb{E}\Phi(p)$.

Proof. The first assertion follows by applying the symmetric transition matrix to the child posterior; the uniform child marginal equals the uniform parent marginal. The second is conditioning on the observed label. For the third, the posterior before the added observation is the conditional expectation of the posterior afterward. Conditional Jensen gives the claim. □

3. An explicit three-state posterior cone

For $p \in \Delta_3$, let $v_i = 3p_i - 1$ and define

$$x(p) = \frac{1}{6}\sum_i v_i^2 = \frac{3\sum_i p_i^2 - 1}{2}, \qquad y(p) = \frac{1}{6}\sum_i v_i^3. \tag{5}$$

The functions used throughout this section are

$$\boxed{H(p) = y(p) - \tfrac{1}{2}x(p)^2, \qquad F(p) = \tfrac{3}{2}x(p) - y(p), \qquad G(p) = 1 - x(p).} \tag{6}$$

Lemma 3.1 (Scalar properties)**.** *For all $p \in \Delta_3$,*

$$0 \le x(p) \le 1, \qquad |y(p)| \le x(p)^{3/2} \le x(p), \qquad F(p) \ge \tfrac{1}{2}x(p) \ge 0, \qquad G(p) \ge 0.$$

The revealing posterior has $H = 1/2$, and the uniform posterior has $H = 0$. Under (4),

$$H\big(u_3 + \lambda(p - u_3)\big) = \lambda^3 H(p) + \tfrac{1}{2}\lambda^3(1 - \lambda)x(p)^2 \ge \lambda^3 H(p) \quad (0 \le \lambda \le 1). \tag{7}$$

Proof. Set $\omega = e^{2\pi i/3}$ and $\zeta = p_1 + \omega p_2 + \omega^2 p_3$. Direct expansion gives $x = |\zeta|^2$ and $y = \mathrm{Re}(\zeta^3)$. Since $|\zeta| \le 1$, all bounds follow. At a point mass $x = y = 1$, whereas both vanish at u_3. Equation (4) multiplies ζ by λ, so x and y scale by λ^2 and λ^3. Substitution yields (7). □

For $p, r \in \Delta_3$ and $\pi \in S_3$, write

$$z_\pi = 3\sum_i p_i r_{\pi(i)}, \qquad P_i^\pi = \frac{3p_i r_{\pi(i)}}{z_\pi} \quad (z_\pi > 0), \qquad [zf(P)] = \frac{1}{6}\sum_{\pi \in S_3} z_\pi f(P^\pi). \tag{8}$$

Terms with $z_\pi = 0$ are zero.

Proposition 3.2 (Global three-state pair inequalities)**.** *With $\varepsilon = 1/1000$, every $p, r \in \Delta_3$ satisfy*

$$[zx(P)] \le x(p) + x(r) - H(p)F(r) - F(p)H(r) - \varepsilon x(p)x(r), \tag{9}$$

$$[zH(P)] \ge H(p)G(r) + G(p)H(r) + \varepsilon x(p)x(r). \tag{10}$$

Proof. We give the exact polynomial certificate and its domain argument. The independent integer implementation and complete verification data are described in Appendix A.

The expressions are invariant under separate permutations of p and r. A sorted vector $p_1 \geq p_2 \geq p_3$ is a convex combination of

$$e = (1,0,0), \qquad h = (1/2,1/2,0), \qquad u = (1/3,1/3,1/3),$$

with coefficients $p_1 - p_2$, $2(p_2 - p_3)$, and $3p_3$. Thus it suffices to work on the product of these two ordered chambers, in nonnegative barycentric triples each summing to one.

For a fixed permutation define

$$U_i = 3p_i r_{\pi(i)}, \qquad Z_\pi = \sum_i U_i, \qquad V_i = 3U_i - Z_\pi,$$
$$X_\pi = \tfrac{1}{6}\sum_i V_i^2, \qquad Y_\pi = \tfrac{1}{6}\sum_i V_i^3, \qquad N_\pi = Y_\pi Z_\pi - \tfrac{1}{2}X_\pi^2.$$

Direct substitution gives $Z_\pi x(P^\pi) = X_\pi/Z_\pi$ and $Z_\pi H(P^\pi) = N_\pi/Z_\pi^3$. Let

$$K_A = x(p) + x(r) - H(p)F(r) - F(p)H(r) - \varepsilon x(p)x(r),$$
$$K_B = -H(p)G(r) - G(p)H(r) - \varepsilon x(p)x(r).$$

The denominator-cleared targets are

$$T_A = 6K_A \prod_\pi Z_\pi - \sum_\pi X_\pi \prod_{\tau\neq\pi} Z_\tau, \tag{11}$$

$$T_B = 6K_B \prod_\pi Z_\pi^3 + \sum_\pi N_\pi \prod_{\tau\neq\pi} Z_\tau^3. \tag{12}$$

Homogenize each coordinate block to degree 10 for T_A and degree 22 for T_B. Multiplication by powers of the coordinate sums leaves values unchanged on the simplex. The supplied exact integer programs produce the following exhaustive coefficient counts:

Target	Total	Positive	Zero	Negative
T_A	4,356	3,873	483	0
T_B	76,176	71,627	4,549	0

Every coefficient is rational with positive denominator. Nonnegative coefficients prove $T_A, T_B \geq 0$ for all nonnegative barycentric coordinates. This is a global certificate on the initial chamber; no subdivision or sampled extrapolation is required. A separately written sparse six-variable implementation regenerates every coefficient and agrees exactly after the explicitly documented positive integer scaling.

For strictly positive p, r, all Z_π are positive, so division recovers (9)–(10). On the boundary, x and H are bounded on the compact simplex. Hence $Z_\pi f(P^\pi) \to 0$ whenever $Z_\pi \to 0$. Approximating each boundary pair by an interior pair proves the stated inequalities everywhere. □

Definition 3.3. Let $\mathcal{C}_3$ be the symmetric posterior laws μ such that $\mathbb{E}_\mu H \geq 0$.

The condition is imposed on an expectation, not on the support of the law. For example, $H(1/2,1/2,0) = -5/32$; such a posterior value is not excluded from an experiment whose average H is nonnegative.

Proposition 3.4 (Closure and strict subadditivity)**.** *The class $\mathcal{C}_3$ contains both full revelation and the uninformative experiment. It is preserved by positive channel steps, observed input-independent mixtures, and conditionally independent products. If $\mu, \nu \in \mathcal{C}_3$ and $m(\mu) = \mathbb{E}_\mu x$, then*

$$m(\mu \star \nu) \leq m(\mu) + m(\nu) - \varepsilon m(\mu)m(\nu). \tag{13}$$

Proof. The initial laws and edge closure follow from Lemma 3.1. Mixture closure follows by linearity and symmetry. For products, integrate (10) against $\mu \otimes \nu$ and use Lemma 2.1:

$$\mathbb{E}_{\mu\star\nu}H \geq (\mathbb{E}_\mu H)(\mathbb{E}_\nu G) + (\mathbb{E}_\mu G)(\mathbb{E}_\nu H) + \varepsilon(\mathbb{E}_\mu x)(\mathbb{E}_\nu x) \geq 0.$$

Product experiments remain symmetric. Integrating (9), the two products involving H and F are nonnegative because $F \geq 0$ and both H expectations are nonnegative. Dropping them proves (13). □

4. Four states: a posterior cone

We use the four-state posterior cone and global pair inequalities of [19] and derive their consequences for arbitrary finite-mean offspring. We state the inequalities and describe their finite certificates explicitly.

For a posterior $p \in \Delta_4$, let

$$\zeta = Lp, \qquad L = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Define

$$A = \zeta_1^2 + \zeta_2^2 + \zeta_3^2 = 4\sum_{i=1}^4 p_i^2 - 1, \qquad B = \zeta_1\zeta_2\zeta_3, \qquad C = \zeta_1^2\zeta_2^2 + \zeta_1^2\zeta_3^2 + \zeta_2^2\zeta_3^2. \tag{14}$$

In particular $0 \leq A \leq 3$. The three polynomials needed below are

$$H_4 = B - \frac{1}{10}A^2 - \frac{3}{20}C + \frac{3}{10}AB - \frac{1}{50}A^3 + \frac{7}{100}AC - \frac{51}{100}B^2, \tag{15}$$

$$F_4 = 4A - 3B + \frac{7}{10}A^2 - 4C - \frac{4}{5}AB, \tag{16}$$

$$G_4 = 1 - \frac{161}{100}A - \frac{31}{10}B + \frac{773}{1000}A^2 + 4C - \frac{199}{50}AB. \tag{17}$$

We regard these both as functions of p and as polynomials in $\zeta = Lp$; the argument will indicate which representation is used.

4.1. The four-state inequalities.

For $p, r \in \Delta_4$ and $\pi \in S_4$, write

$$U_i^\pi = 4p_i r_{\pi(i)}, \qquad z_\pi = \sum_{i=1}^4 U_i^\pi, \qquad P_i^\pi = \frac{U_i^\pi}{z_\pi} \quad (z_\pi > 0).$$

For a bounded function f on Δ_4, use the notation

$$[zf(P)]_4(p, r) = \frac{1}{24}\sum_{\pi\in S_4} z_\pi f(P^\pi),$$

where a summand with $z_\pi = 0$ is defined to be zero. Thus the brackets average over all twenty-four relative color permutations.

Proposition 4.1 (Four-state polynomial inequalities, [19])**.** *The polynomials* (15)–(17) *satisfy*

$$H_4 \geq -\frac{1}{2}, \qquad F_4 \geq 0, \qquad G_4 \geq 0 \quad \text{on } \Delta_4.$$

For $0 \leq t \leq 1$ *and* $\zeta \in L\Delta_4$*,*

$$H_4(t\zeta) \geq t^3 H_4(\zeta). \tag{18}$$

For every $p, r \in \Delta_4$,

$$[zA(P)]_4(p,r) \le A(p) + A(r) - H_4(p)F_4(r) - F_4(p)H_4(r) - \frac{A(p)A(r)(A(p)+A(r))}{1000}, \tag{19}$$

$$[zH_4(P)]_4(p,r) \ge H_4(p)G_4(r) + G_4(p)H_4(r). \tag{20}$$

4.2. **Finite certificates for the four-state inequalities.** We summarize the exact verification in [19] to specify precisely the four-state computational ingredient. Permuting the four probabilities acts on Lp by a signed permutation of three coordinates, with the product of the three signs equal to one. Consequently A, B, C and H_4, F_4, G_4 are invariant. The averaged pair expressions are invariant under separate permutations of p and r.

It therefore suffices to work on the ordered simplex

$$\mathcal{S}_4 = \{p \in \Delta_4 : p_1 \ge p_2 \ge p_3 \ge p_4\},$$

whose vertices are

$$e_1, \quad \frac{e_1+e_2}{2}, \quad \frac{e_1+e_2+e_3}{3}, \quad u_4.$$

Indeed its barycentric coordinates are $p_1-p_2, 2(p_2-p_3), 3(p_3-p_4), 4p_4$. On a simplex, a homogeneous polynomial with nonnegative ordinary monomial coefficients is nonnegative. Homogenization by powers of the sum of the barycentric coordinates does not alter values on the simplex. This gives the following exact scalar certificates; the displayed minimum refers to ordinary homogeneous coefficients.

Polynomial	Degree	Coefficients	Minimum
$H_4 + 1/2$	6	84	19/50
F_4	5	56	0
G_4	14	680	87/1000
$(3-\mathcal{D})H_4$	6	84	0

Here $\mathcal{D} = \sum_{j=1}^{3} \zeta_j \partial_{\zeta_j}$ is the Euler operator. Its scalar certificate implies (18), because

$$\frac{d}{dt}(t^{-3}H_4(t\zeta)) = t^{-4}(\mathcal{D}-3)H_4(t\zeta) \le 0 \qquad (0 < t \le 1),$$

and $H_4(0) = 0$ handles $t = 0$.

For the pair inequalities, define

$$D_0(p,r) = \frac{A(p)A(r)(A(p)+A(r))}{1000},$$
$$K_a = 24\big(A(p) + A(r) - H_4(p)F_4(r) - F_4(p)H_4(r) - D_0(p,r)\big),$$
$$K_b = -24\big(H_4(p)G_4(r) + G_4(p)H_4(r)\big).$$

The two targets have the common form

$$\mathcal{R} = K + \sum_{\pi \in S_4} \frac{N_\pi}{z_\pi^k}, \tag{21}$$

with the following data:

Target	k	N_π	m
a	1	$-\|LU^\pi\|_2^2$	3
b	5	$z_\pi^6 H_4(U^\pi/z_\pi)$	1/2

The numerator in the second row is polynomial: each degree-s term of H_4 is multiplied by z_π^{6-s} after substitution. The two values of $\mathcal{R}$ are exactly twenty-four times the respective nonnegative differences in (19) and (20).

The verifier covers $\mathcal{S}_4 \times \mathcal{S}_4$ by products of rational subsimplices. On each cell it applies one of two sufficient, exact coefficient tests.

The first test uses

$$t_k(z) = \sum_{j=0}^{5} \binom{-k}{j} (z-1)^j \le z^{-k} \qquad (z > 0).$$

Taylor's theorem proves the inequality on the entire positive half-line: the sixth derivative of z^{-k} is positive, and the remainder contains the nonnegative factor $(z-1)^6$. The scalar bounds above give $N_\pi + m z_\pi^{k+1} \ge 0$. Hence

$$\frac{N_\pi}{z_\pi^k} \ge (N_\pi + m z_\pi^{k+1}) t_k(z_\pi) - m z_\pi.$$

Nonnegative homogeneous coefficients of the sum of these polynomial lower bounds and K certify the cell. The nonnegative multiplier is necessary; one cannot multiply a lower bound by an uncontrolled signed numerator.

For the second test, choose rational bihomogeneous polynomials J_π of bidegree $(3,3)$. With $W_j(X,Y) = (\sum_i X_i)^j (\sum_i Y_i)^j$, form

$$O_\pi = W_2 N_\pi - z_\pi^k J_\pi, \qquad Q_\pi = z_\pi^k W_3.$$

These are both of bidegree $(k+3, k+3)$, and Q_π has nonnegative coefficients. The checker chooses a rational $c_\pi \ge 0$ such that every coefficient of $O_\pi + c_\pi Q_\pi$ is nonnegative. A negative coefficient of O_π at a zero coefficient of Q_π makes this test fail. Otherwise the required correction is obtained by rounding each necessary coefficient ratio upward to a multiple of 2^{-32} and taking the largest correction. On the interior of the cell this proves

$$\frac{N_\pi}{z_\pi^k} = J_\pi - c_\pi + \frac{O_\pi + c_\pi Q_\pi}{z_\pi^k} \ge J_\pi - c_\pi.$$

The cell is accepted when the homogeneous coefficients of $K + \sum_\pi (J_\pi - c_\pi)$ are all nonnegative, after degree elevation. The polynomials J_π in the source are obtained by rational interpolation on the degree-three simplex lattice. Their interpolation accuracy is not assumed: the full remainder is certified by the displayed identity.

Unaccepted cells are bisected at an edge midpoint. If vertex i is replaced by the midpoint of vertices i, j, the barycentric substitution is

$$X_i = X_i'/2, \qquad X_j = X_j' + X_i'/2.$$

The binomial expansion gives exact rational coefficients for the child cell. The two choices of the replaced endpoint cover the original simplex, corresponding to $X_i \le X_j$ and $X_j \le X_i$. Repeating this construction therefore proves coverage, rather than merely testing a set of posterior points.

The full integer verifier of [19], with assertions enabled, was replayed for both targets. It terminated with the following counts and no unresolved cells:

Target	Visited cells	Maximum depth	Taylor leaves	Remainder leaves
a	4,479	19	166	2,074
b	1,935	20	97	871

The scalar coefficients and the twenty-four induced coordinate actions were also checked independently by rational arithmetic. All sign decisions in the certificates use integer numerators and positive exact denominators.

Finally, denominator clearing and the lower bounds above are used first on cell interiors, where every $z_\pi > 0$. The weighted terms $z_\pi A(P^\pi)$ and $z_\pi H_4(P^\pi)$ converge to zero when $z_\pi \to 0$, since A, H_4 are bounded on Δ_4. They therefore have continuous extensions to every boundary point. This proves the boundary cases without dividing by a vanishing denominator. The original source contains the complete verifier and its deterministic subdivision rule.

4.3. **Closure of the four-state cone.** Let $\mathcal{C}_4$ consist of the permutation-symmetric posterior laws μ satisfying $\mathbb{E}_\mu H_4 \geq 0$. The condition is imposed on the law, not on each posterior in its support. Full revelation belongs to the cone because $H_4(e_i) = 13/100$; the uninformative experiment belongs because $H_4(u_4) = 0$.

Lemma 4.2 (Four-state experiment closure)**.** *The class $\mathcal{C}_4$ is preserved by a channel edge with $0 \leq \lambda \leq 1$, by conditionally independent products, and by observed mixtures with an input-independent mixing label. If $\mu, \nu \in \mathcal{C}_4$, and $a = \mathbb{E}_\mu A$, $b = \mathbb{E}_\nu A$, then*

$$\mathbb{E}_{\mu\star\nu} A \leq a + b - \frac{(\mathbb{E}_\mu A^2)b + a(\mathbb{E}_\nu A^2)}{1000} \leq a + b - \frac{ab(a+b)}{1000}. \tag{22}$$

Proof. An edge sends p to $u_4 + \lambda(p - u_4)$, and hence sends Lp to λLp. Equation (18) preserves the expectation condition, and A is multiplied by λ^2.

For the product of two experiments, the expectation of a posterior functional f is

$$\mathbb{E}_{\mu\star\nu} f = \mathbb{E}_{\mu\otimes\nu}[z f(P)].$$

The laws in the reference measure $\mu \otimes \nu$ are independent; the factor z gives the actual joint observation law. By permutation symmetry, averaging the integrand over the relative permutations does not change the expectation. Integrating (20) therefore gives

$$\mathbb{E}_{\mu\star\nu} H_4 \geq (\mathbb{E}_\mu H_4)(\mathbb{E}_\nu G_4) + (\mathbb{E}_\mu G_4)(\mathbb{E}_\nu H_4) \geq 0.$$

The product is symmetric as well. Integrating (19) and discarding the nonnegative products involving F_4 gives the first inequality in (22). Jensen's inequality gives the second. Observed input-independent mixtures preserve both symmetry and the expectation condition by linearity. □

5. Nonreconstruction for arbitrary finite-mean offspring

Let D be a nonnegative, almost surely finite integer-valued random variable with $d = \mathbb{E}D < \infty$, and let T be the associated Galton–Watson tree. The tree and all auxiliary child orderings are independent of the spins. The observer knows the tree and the spins at generation n. Knowing the continuation of the tree beyond that generation adds no spin information conditional on the observed finite prefix.

For $q = 3, 4$, write p_n for the posterior of the uniformly distributed root spin. Use the quadratic statistics

$$J_3(p) = \frac{3\sum_{i=1}^3 p_i^2 - 1}{2}, \qquad J_4(p) = 4\sum_{i=1}^4 p_i^2 - 1, \qquad m_n^{(q)} = \mathbb{E}J_q(p_n).$$

Thus $J_3 = x$ in the three-state section and $J_4 = A$ in the preceding section. Initially $m_0^{(3)} = 1$ and $m_0^{(4)} = 3$. Set

$$\rho = d\lambda^2, \qquad \delta = \mathbb{E}(D-1)_+ = d - \mathbb{P}(D \geq 1). \tag{23}$$

Only the first offspring moment is involved in δ.

Proposition 5.1 (Quadratic and cubic drift)**.** *For $0 \le \lambda \le 1$ and every $n \ge 0$,*

$$m_{n+1}^{(3)} \le \rho m_n^{(3)} - c_3 \big(m_n^{(3)}\big)^2, \qquad c_3 = \frac{\delta\lambda^4}{1000}, \tag{24}$$

$$m_{n+1}^{(4)} \le \rho m_n^{(4)} - c_4 \big(m_n^{(4)}\big)^3, \qquad c_4 = \frac{\delta\lambda^6}{500}. \tag{25}$$

Proof. At depth zero the fully revealing experiment belongs to the appropriate cone. Edge attenuation, conditionally independent products, and observed offspring mixtures show inductively that every finite-depth experiment belongs to that cone. These closures also apply to every partial product of incoming branch experiments.

Condition on $D = k$ and put $b = \lambda^2 m_n^{(q)}$. Every child branch has mean statistic b, since one channel edge multiplies the quadratic statistic by λ^2. If $j \ge 1$ branches have already been observed, their partial product has mean statistic at least b. To see this, let $P^{(j)}$ be the posterior after those j branches and $P^{(1)}$ the posterior after the first branch. The tower property gives

$$P^{(1)} = \mathbb{E}[P^{(j)} \mid \text{first branch observation}],$$

and conditional Jensen applies because both J_3 and J_4 are convex.

The three-state pair inequality proved earlier gives, for a partial product with mean $a \ge b$ and one further branch,

$$m(\text{new product}) \le a + b - \frac{ab}{1000} \le a + b - \frac{b^2}{1000}.$$

Applying this at each of the $k-1$ fusions, and including $k = 0, 1$, yields

$$\mathbb{E}[J_3(p_{n+1}) \mid D = k] \le kb - \frac{(k-1)_+ b^2}{1000}.$$

For four states, (22) instead gives a saving of at least

$$\frac{ab(a+b)}{1000} \ge \frac{b^3}{500}$$

at each fusion. Therefore

$$\mathbb{E}[J_4(p_{n+1}) \mid D = k] \le kb - \frac{(k-1)_+ b^3}{500}.$$

Averaging over the observed offspring count proves both recursions. The expectation is finite because $\mathbb{E}D < \infty$. □

Proposition 5.2 (Decay at and below the Kesten–Stigum value)**.** *Assume $0 < \lambda < 1$ and $\rho \le 1$. Let*

$$a_n^{(q)} = \mathbb{E}\,\mathrm{TV}(p_n, u_q).$$

If $\rho < 1$, then

$$m_n^{(3)} \le \rho^n, \qquad a_n^{(3)} \le \frac{\rho^{n/2}}{\sqrt{2}}, \tag{26}$$

$$m_n^{(4)} \le 3\rho^n, \qquad a_n^{(4)} \le \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}\rho^{n/2}. \tag{27}$$

If $\rho = 1$, then $c_3, c_4 > 0$ and

$$m_n^{(3)} \le \frac{1}{1 + c_3 n}, \qquad a_n^{(3)} \le \frac{1}{\sqrt{2(1 + c_3 n)}}, \tag{28}$$

$$m_n^{(4)} \le (1/9 + 2c_4 n)^{-1/2}, \qquad a_n^{(4)} \le \frac{1}{2}(1/9 + 2c_4 n)^{-1/4}. \tag{29}$$

In both cases nonreconstruction holds for almost every realized tree.

Proof. Below criticality, omit the negative terms in (24)–(25) and iterate. The total-variation estimates follow from Cauchy–Schwarz:

$$\mathrm{TV}(p, u_3) \le \sqrt{J_3(p)/2}, \qquad \mathrm{TV}(p, u_4) \le \frac{1}{2}\sqrt{J_4(p)},$$

followed by Jensen's inequality.

At $\rho = 1$, the condition $\lambda < 1$ implies $d > 1$, and hence $\delta = d - \mathbb{P}(D \ge 1) > 0$. For three states, while $m_n = m_n^{(3)} > 0$,

$$\frac{1}{m_{n+1}} \ge \frac{1}{m_n(1 - c_3 m_n)} \ge \frac{1}{m_n} + c_3.$$

The denominator is positive: $m_n \le 1$ and $c_3 \le d\lambda^4/1000 \le 1/1000$ when $\rho \le 1$. If an iterate is zero, all subsequent iterates are zero and the stated bound is immediate. Otherwise iteration from $m_0 = 1$ proves (28).

For four states, write $m_n = m_n^{(4)}$. Since $m_n \le 3$ and $c_4 m_n^2 \le 9d\lambda^6/500 \le 9/500 < 1$, the analogous calculation gives

$$\frac{1}{m_{n+1}^2} \ge \frac{1}{m_n^2}(1 - c_4 m_n^2)^{-2} \ge \frac{1}{m_n^2} + 2c_4.$$

Iteration from $m_0 = 3$, with the same zero-iterate convention, proves (29).

For a fixed locally finite tree T, put

$$a_n^{(q)}(T) = \mathbb{E}[\mathrm{TV}(p_n, u_q) \mid T].$$

The root spin, level n, and level $n+1$ form a Markov chain, so $a_n^{(q)}(T)$ is nonincreasing by data processing. Its nonnegative limit therefore exists. The annealed estimates show that its expectation tends to zero. Bounded convergence yields

$$\mathbb{E}\big[\lim_{n\to\infty} a_n^{(q)}(T)\big] = 0,$$

so the limit is zero for almost every tree. The conclusion also holds almost surely conditional on survival whenever survival has positive probability. No independence assumption after conditioning on survival is needed. □

6. Reconstruction above the threshold

The argument in this section works for every finite number of states $q \ge 2$. It supplies the supercritical direction with only a finite first offspring moment.

Proposition 6.1 (Bounded pruning)**.** *Let $\mathbb{E}D = d < \infty$ and $0 < \lambda < 1$. If $d\lambda^2 > 1$, then the annealed reconstruction advantage is bounded away from zero uniformly in depth.*

Proof. By monotone convergence, choose $L < \infty$ such that

$$D_L = \min(D, L), \qquad \mu = \mathbb{E}D_L, \qquad \mu\lambda^2 > 1.$$

Keep the first D_L children at every retained vertex, using a child ordering independent of the spins. The retained subtree has iid bounded offspring D_L, and its depth-n spins are part of the original depth-n observation.

Choose a channel eigenfunction ϕ with uniform mean zero and second moment one; for example,

$$\phi(1) = \sqrt{q-1}, \qquad \phi(i) = -\frac{1}{\sqrt{q-1}} \quad (2 \le i \le q).$$

It satisfies $\mathbb{E}[\phi(\sigma_{\text{child}}) \mid \sigma_{\text{parent}}] = \lambda\phi(\sigma_{\text{parent}})$ and $|\phi| \le B_q := \sqrt{q-1}$. On the retained tree define

$$Z_n = (\mu\lambda)^{-n} \sum_{|v|=n} \phi(\sigma_v).$$

The first-moment recursion gives

$$\mathbb{E}[Z_n \mid \sigma_{\text{root}}] = \phi(\sigma_{\text{root}}), \qquad \mathbb{E}[\phi(\sigma_{\text{root}})Z_n] = 1. \tag{30}$$

Let $M_n = \mathbb{E}Z_n^2$ and $\alpha_L = \mathbb{E}[D_L(D_L-1)]/\mu^2$. Writing the depth-$(n+1)$ sum as a sum of child contributions gives

$$M_{n+1} = \frac{M_n}{\mu\lambda^2} + \alpha_L, \qquad M_0 = 1. \tag{31}$$

Indeed the diagonal terms have total expectation μM_n. For distinct children, conditional independence given the root and (30) give product expectation $\lambda^2\phi(\sigma_{\text{root}})^2$, whose mean is λ^2. Dividing by $(\mu\lambda)^2$ proves (31). Since D_L is bounded and $r_L = (\mu\lambda^2)^{-1} < 1$,

$$M_n \le C_L := 1 + \frac{\alpha_L}{1-r_L} < \infty \qquad \text{for all } n.$$

Let $\mathcal{F}_n$ contain the original tree, its level-n spins, and the auxiliary ordering. The statistic Z_n is $\mathcal{F}_n$-measurable. Put $\eta_n = \mathbb{E}[\phi(\sigma_{\text{root}}) \mid \mathcal{F}_n]$. Cauchy–Schwarz and (30) imply

$$1 = \mathbb{E}[\eta_n Z_n] \le \left(\mathbb{E}\eta_n^2\, C_L\right)^{1/2}, \qquad \mathbb{E}\eta_n^2 \ge C_L^{-1}.$$

The ordering is independent of the root and spins conditional on the original observed tree. Consequently adjoining it does not change the root posterior. For that posterior,

$$|\eta_n| \le B_q, \qquad \mathrm{TV}(p_n, u_q) \ge \frac{|\eta_n|}{2B_q}.$$

Therefore

$$a_n^{(q)} \ge \frac{\mathbb{E}|\eta_n|}{2B_q} \ge \frac{\mathbb{E}\eta_n^2}{2B_q^2} \ge \frac{1}{2(q-1)C_L} > 0. \tag{32}$$

Only the truncated offspring variable was required to have a second moment. □

Lemma 6.2 (The reconstruction event on a Galton–Watson tree)**.** *For $0 < \lambda < 1$ and $d\lambda^2 > 1$, reconstruction holds for almost every surviving Galton–Watson tree and fails on the extinction event.*

Proof. First fix a deterministic locally finite rooted tree. Its root reconstructs if and only if at least one of its child subtrees reconstructs. If a child reconstructs, observing only that child's descendants gives the root posterior

$$u_q + \lambda(p_{\text{child}} - u_q).$$

Its total-variation advantage is λ times the child's advantage, so remains positive in the limit.

Conversely, suppose all child subtrees are nonreconstructing. For a finite input alphabet, vanishing expected posterior total variation implies vanishing mutual information: the posterior relative entropy from the uniform prior is bounded and continuous on the compact simplex. Thus every child's boundary observation has vanishing mutual information with the child spin and, by data processing, with the root spin. There are only finitely many children. Their observations $Y_1, \dots, Y_k$ are independent conditional on the root, and hence

$$I(\sigma_{\text{root}}; Y_1, \dots, Y_k) \le \sum_{j=1}^{k} I(\sigma_{\text{root}}; Y_j) \longrightarrow 0.$$

Here the inequality follows from subadditivity of unconditional entropy and additivity of conditional entropy. Pinsker's inequality then implies nonreconstruction at the root.

Let r_* be the probability that a Galton–Watson tree reconstructs. The preceding equivalence and independence of child subtrees yield

$$r_* = 1 - \mathbb{E}(1 - r_*)^D.$$

Let ξ be the extinction probability. Since $d\lambda^2 > 1$ implies $d > 1$, the offspring generating function has exactly the two fixed points ξ and 1 in $[0, 1]$. For completeness, it is strictly convex on $(0, 1)$ because $\mathbb{P}(D \geq 2) > 0$; its derivative at 1 equals $d > 1$, and ξ is its least fixed point. These facts exclude any third fixed point.

The positive lower bound (32), together with bounded convergence for the fixed-tree advantage, implies $r_* > 0$. Thus $1 - r_* = \xi$. Reconstruction is impossible on an extinct tree, whose boundary is eventually empty. Consequently the reconstruction event agrees with survival up to a null set. □

7. The finite-mean dichotomy and endpoint conventions

Theorem 7.1 (Three and four states on finite-mean Galton–Watson trees)**.** *Let D be a nonnegative, almost surely finite integer-valued random variable with finite mean d. Consider the symmetric ferromagnetic q-state broadcast process on its observed Galton–Watson tree, with $q \in \{3, 4\}$ and $0 < \lambda < 1$. If $d\lambda^2 \leq 1$, nonreconstruction holds for almost every tree. If $d\lambda^2 > 1$, reconstruction holds for almost every surviving tree and fails on extinct trees. In particular, annealed reconstruction occurs if and only if*

$$d\lambda^2 > 1.$$

No offspring moment beyond $\mathbb{E}D < \infty$ is assumed. At equality, the quantitative bounds are (28) *and* (29)*.*

Proof. Proposition 5.2 proves the assertion at and below equality. Proposition 6.1 and Lemma 6.2 prove the assertions above equality. □

Remark 7.2 (Regular trees and endpoints)*.* Taking $D \equiv d$ gives every regular tree of integer degree $d \geq 2$. At $\lambda = 0$, all positive-depth observations are independent of the root. At $\lambda = 1$, every descendant copies the root, so reconstruction is perfect on survival and impossible after extinction. A subcritical or nondegenerate critical finite-mean Galton–Watson process dies out almost surely. The exceptional law $D \equiv 1$ instead gives an infinite noiseless line: at $\lambda = 1$ it reconstructs perfectly although $d\lambda^2 = 1$. A statement including all closed endpoints must record this exception. The argument concerns nonnegative channel eigenvalues; it makes no assertion about the antiferromagnetic case.

Acknowledgments and funding

The research presented in this paper was supported by the European Research Council (ERC) under the European Union's Horizon Europe research and innovation programme (grant agreement No. 101041711), by the Simons Foundation as part of the Collaboration on the Mathematical and Scientific Foundations of Deep Learning, by Heights Labs, by Convex Nexus Capital, by the Israel Science Foundation (grant number 2258/19), and by the Israel Science Foundation (ISF Grant 4101/25).

This work was done by multiple AI agents, Claude (Anthropic) and Codex (OpenAI), connected to Math Brain [20] and working together inside the Brain framework [22], a shared, persistent memory in which the agents record claims, proofs, failed attempts and methods, retrieve one another's results, coordinate who works on what, and audit each other's work. For more on the details behind the Brain and Math Brain, see the Math Brain paper [21], the Math Brain repository [20] and the Brain framework repository [22].

Declaration of competing interest

The author holds equity in Heights Labs and in Convex Nexus Capital and has a management role at Convex Nexus Capital. These entities are included in the funding declaration above.

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies

The three-state argument, the finite-mean offspring deductions, the literature search, the verification code and the manuscript were produced by OpenAI AI systems under the author's direction. The four-state posterior-cone theorem is prior work and is attributed explicitly in the text. The computations were checked by exact certificate reruns and an independent reconstruction of all three-state polynomial coefficients. The author selected the problem and commissioned and directed the work; the author did not carry out the mathematics or the writing. Responsibility for any decision to submit or publish the manuscript rests with the author.

Appendix A. Exact coefficient certificates and reproducibility

This appendix specifies the finite arithmetic certificates used in the proof. The three-state inequalities are verified by two different polynomial constructions. The four-state inequalities use the published certificate of [19], whose two complete traversals were rerun. All sign decisions use integer or rational arithmetic.

A.1. **The three-state residuals and their complete domain.** For $p \in \Delta_3$, retain the definitions

$$x(p) = \frac{1}{6}\sum_i (3p_i - 1)^2, \qquad y(p) = \frac{1}{6}\sum_i (3p_i - 1)^3, \qquad H = y - \frac{x^2}{2}, \quad F = \frac{3}{2}x - y, \quad G = 1 - x.$$

For $\pi \in S_3$, put

$$z_\pi = 3\sum_i p_i q_{\pi(i)}, \qquad r_{\pi,i} = \frac{3p_i q_{\pi(i)}}{z_\pi}, \qquad \epsilon = \frac{1}{1000}.$$

A term $z_\pi f(r_\pi)$ is defined as zero when $z_\pi = 0$. The two residuals certified below are

$$\begin{aligned} R_A(p,q) &= x(p) + x(q) - \frac{1}{6}\sum_{\pi\in S_3} z_\pi x(r_\pi) \\ &\quad - H(p)F(q) - F(p)H(q) - \epsilon x(p)x(q), \end{aligned} \tag{33}$$

$$\begin{aligned} R_B(p,q) &= \frac{1}{6}\sum_{\pi\in S_3} z_\pi H(r_\pi) \\ &\quad - H(p)G(q) - G(p)H(q) - \epsilon x(p)x(q). \end{aligned} \tag{34}$$

It suffices to work in the ordered chambers for p and q: all scalar functions are symmetric, and the fusion terms average over every relative permutation. Introduce nonnegative variables (a, b, c), (d, e, f), and let $S = a + b + c > 0$, $T = d + e + f > 0$. Set

$$p = \frac{(6a + 3b + 2c,\ 3b + 2c,\ 2c)}{6S}, \qquad q = \frac{(6d + 3e + 2f,\ 3e + 2f,\ 2f)}{6T}.$$

This covers the whole ordered simplex. Indeed, for $p_1 \geq p_2 \geq p_3$, the normalized coordinates

$$(a, b, c) = (p_1 - p_2,\ 2(p_2 - p_3),\ 3p_3)$$

are nonnegative and sum to one. Thus the certificate is not restricted to sampled posterior vectors or to a neighborhood of the uniform law.

A.2. **An explicit integer polynomial certificate.** Define

$$X = 4a^2 + 2ab + b^2, \qquad Y = 8a^3 + 6a^2b - 3ab^2 - b^3,$$

and use primes for the same expressions in (d, e, f). Direct substitution gives

$$x(p) = \frac{X}{4S^2}, \qquad y(p) = \frac{Y}{8S^3}.$$

Writing

$$\widehat{H} = 4YS - X^2, \qquad \widehat{F} = 3XS - Y, \qquad \widehat{G} = 4S^2 - X,$$

we have

$$H(p) = \frac{\widehat{H}}{32S^4}, \qquad F(p) = \frac{\widehat{F}}{8S^3}, \qquad G(p) = \frac{\widehat{G}}{4S^2}.$$

The auxiliary signs used in the expectation argument follow, for example, from the explicit expansions

$$\widehat{F} = 4a^3 + 12a^2b + 12ab^2 + 4b^3 + 12a^2c + 6abc + 3b^2c,$$
$$\widehat{G} = 6ab + 8ac + 3b^2 + 8bc + 4c^2.$$

Let $P = (6a + 3b + 2c, 3b + 2c, 2c)$ and $Q = (6d + 3e + 2f, 3e + 2f, 2f)$. For each permutation define

$$U_{\pi,i} = P_i Q_{\pi(i)}, \quad Z_\pi = \sum_i U_{\pi,i}, \quad W_{\pi,i} = 3U_{\pi,i} - Z_\pi,$$

$$V_\pi = \sum_i W_{\pi,i}^2, \qquad J_\pi = 36 Z_\pi W_{\pi,1} W_{\pi,2} W_{\pi,3} - V_\pi^2.$$

Since $\sum_i W_{\pi,i} = 0$, the weighted fusion terms satisfy

$$z_\pi = \frac{Z_\pi}{12ST}, \qquad x(r_\pi) = \frac{V_\pi}{6Z_\pi^2}, \qquad H(r_\pi) = \frac{J_\pi}{72Z_\pi^4}.$$

In particular, the factor z_π from the posterior product law reduces the denominator powers to one and three.

Set $D_A = \prod_\pi Z_\pi$, $D_B = \prod_\pi Z_\pi^3$, and define

$$K_A = 8000(XS^2T^4 + X'S^4T^2) - 125(\widehat{H}\widehat{F}'T + \widehat{F}\widehat{H}'S) - 2XX'S^2T^2,$$
$$K_B = -125(\widehat{H}\widehat{G}'T^2 + \widehat{G}\widehat{H}'S^2) - XX'S^2T^2.$$

The following two polynomials have integer coefficients:

$$\mathcal{P}_A = 27K_AD_A - 2000S^3T^3 \sum_\pi V_\pi \prod_{\rho \neq \pi} Z_\rho, \tag{35}$$

$$\mathcal{P}_B = 81K_BD_B + 250S^3T^3 \sum_\pi J_\pi \prod_{\rho \neq \pi} Z_\rho^3. \tag{36}$$

Their exact relation to the desired residuals is

$$\mathcal{P}_A = 864000S^4T^4D_AR_A, \qquad \mathcal{P}_B = 1296000S^4T^4D_BR_B. \tag{37}$$

Expanding (35)–(36) in the six nonnegative barycentric variables gives the complete coefficient inventory:

Certificate	Bidegree	Positions	Positive	Zero	Negative
A	$(10, 10)$	4 356	3 873	483	0
B	$(22, 22)$	76 176	71 627	4 549	0

The number of positions is $\binom{n+2}{2}^2$ in bidegree (n,n). Every coefficient is checked; no subdivision is needed for these three-state polynomials.

Nonnegative coefficients imply $\mathcal{P}_A, \mathcal{P}_B \geq 0$. For interior probability vectors, $Z_\pi > 0$ for all π, so (37) proves $R_A, R_B \geq 0$. Boundary points are included by continuity: x and H are bounded on the probability simplex, hence $z_\pi x(r_\pi)$ and $z_\pi H(r_\pi)$ tend to zero when z_π tends to zero. Approximation by interior pairs therefore establishes (33)–(34) on the entire domain.

A.3. **Independent verification.** The source `analytic/q3_exact_pair_simple.cpp` constructs rational homogeneous polynomials directly from the definitions of the posterior invariants. Separately, `computation/q3_independent_coefficients.cpp` expands (35)–(36) in a sparse six-variable integer representation. Its construction does not use the first encoder's invariants, homogenization, tensor multiplication, or rational-polynomial operations. Only after constructing its polynomials does it call the first encoder to compare the complete coefficient arrays.

If $\mathcal{C}_A, \mathcal{C}_B$ denote the rational homogeneous outputs of the first encoder, every coefficient satisfies the exact identities

$$\mathcal{P}_A = 144000 \cdot 12^6\, \mathcal{C}_A, \qquad \mathcal{P}_B = 216000 \cdot 12^{18}\, \mathcal{C}_B.$$

The comparison uses integer cross-products with the stored denominators. Both constructions use arbitrary-precision integers. The independent implementation packs six exponents into five-bit fields and checks that each group's total degree is below 32; the maximum used is 22, so exponent addition cannot carry between fields.

Both implementations completed with assertions enabled and UndefinedBehaviorSanitizer. The clean certificates accept at their root, so floating-point edge-selection coordinates in the first encoder are never consulted. No sampled inequality or floating-point sign decision is used.

The supplementary files contain both implementations, the complete coefficient tables, and the verification output. The independent program regenerates every coefficient, including all zeros.

A.4. **Four-state certificate.** The four-state pair inequalities and their certificate algorithm are those of [19]; the supplementary files include the unchanged verifier from the version linked in that reference.

The verifier works on products of ordered posterior simplices and sums over all 24 relative colour permutations. It certifies subdomains using either a Taylor lower bound for reciprocal powers with a nonnegative multiplier, or cubic interpolation with a rigorously bounded cleared polynomial remainder. Exact midpoint bisection covers a subdomain whenever neither certificate yet applies. A successful traversal certifies every resulting subdomain; see [19] for the inequalities and the justification of these two tests.

Both full traversals were executed with the published C++ source unchanged, exact integer/rational arithmetic, and assertions enabled:

Mode	Nodes	Max. depth	Interpolation leaves	Taylor leaves
A	4 479	19	2 074	166
B	1 935	20	871	97

Both exited with status zero. Their terminal lines were

```
done 4479 19 lp=2074 lt=166
done 1935 20 lp=871 lt=97
```

Complete output records are included with the supplementary code.

Additional checks verify the four homogeneous scalar polynomials' coefficient minima, all 24 symmetry actions, and the exact arithmetic, interpolation, and subdivision operations under UndefinedBehaviorSanitizer. The scalar coefficient minima are $19/50, 0, 87/1000, 0$ for $H + 1/2, F, G, (3 - \mathrm{Euler})H$,

respectively; these are coefficient minima, not asserted minima of the functions. The lightweight checks are supplemented by the two complete traversals reported above.

A.5. **Compact reproduction instructions.** The accompanying source archive preserves the cited files and their relative paths. Requirements are Python 3, a C++17 compiler with the GCC-compatible headers used by the published verifier, and Boost multiprecision headers. Keep assertions enabled. If Boost is outside the compiler's default include path, set `CPLUS_INCLUDE_PATH` to its include directory. From the archive root:

```
cd computation
g++ -std=c++17 -O2 -UNDEBUG -fsanitize=undefined \
  -fno-sanitize-recover=all \
  ../analytic/q3_exact_pair_simple.cpp -o q3_check
./q3_check 0
./q3_check 1
g++ -std=c++17 -O2 -UNDEBUG -fsanitize=undefined \
  -fno-sanitize-recover=all \
  q3_independent_coefficients.cpp -o q3_independent
./q3_independent 0
./q3_independent 1
cd published_q4/verification
python3 checks/verify.py
g++ -std=c++17 -O3 -UNDEBUG \
  checks/certificate.cpp -o artifacts/certificate
./artifacts/certificate
./artifacts/certificate b
```

Every command must exit with status zero. The q3 outputs must reproduce the coefficient counts above, and the q4 executions must print the two stated completion lines. The probabilistic deductions from these algebraic inequalities are supplied in the main text.

Code availability

The supplementary material contains the complete LaTeX source, both three-state verification programs, the full coefficient tables, and the four-state verifier of [19], with instructions for reproducing the exact checks. The version of the four-state source is identified in the bibliography.

The code and data for this paper are at https://github.com/yspennstate/posterior-cones-reconstruction. The paper is part of the Math Brain project, whose public repository is https://github.com/yspennstate/math-brain-public [20].

References

[1] P. M. Bleher, J. Ruiz and V. A. Zagrebnov, *On the purity of the limiting Gibbs state for the Ising model on the Bethe lattice*, J. Stat. Phys. **79** (1995), 473–482.

[2] A. Decelle, F. Krzakala, C. Moore and L. Zdeborová, *Asymptotic analysis of the stochastic block model for modular networks and its algorithmic applications*, Phys. Rev. E **84** (2011), 066106.

[3] W. Evans, C. Kenyon, Y. Peres and L. J. Schulman, *Broadcasting on trees and the Ising model*, Ann. Appl. Probab. **10** (2000), 410–433.

[4] M. Formentin and C. Külske, *On the purity of the free boundary condition Potts measure on random trees*, Stochastic Process. Appl. **119** (2009), 2992–3005. arXiv:0810.0677.

[5] M. Formentin and C. Külske, *A symmetric entropy bound on the non-reconstruction regime of Markov chains on Galton–Watson trees*, Electron. Commun. Probab. **14** (2009), 587–596.

[6] Y. Gu and Y. Polyanskiy, *Non-linear log-Sobolev inequalities for the Potts semigroup and applications to reconstruction problems*, Comm. Math. Phys. **404** (2023), 769–831.

[7] S. Janson and E. Mossel, *Robust reconstruction on trees is determined by the second eigenvalue*, Ann. Probab. **32** (2004), 2630–2649.
[8] H. Kesten and B. P. Stigum, *Additional limit theorems for indecomposable multidimensional Galton–Watson processes*, Ann. Math. Statist. **37** (1966), 1463–1481.
[9] M. Mézard and A. Montanari, *Reconstruction on trees and spin glass transition*, J. Stat. Phys. **124** (2006), 1317–1350.
[10] E. Mossel, *Reconstruction on trees: beating the second eigenvalue*, Ann. Appl. Probab. **11** (2001), 285–300.
[11] E. Mossel and Y. Peres, *Information flow on trees*, Ann. Appl. Probab. **13** (2003), 817–844.
[12] E. Mossel, A. Sly and Y. Sohn, *Exact phase transitions for stochastic block models and reconstruction on trees*, Ann. Probab. **53** (2025), 967–1018. arXiv:2212.03362.
[13] R. Pemantle and Y. Peres, *The critical Ising model on trees, concave recursions and nonlinear capacity*, Ann. Probab. **38** (2010), 184–206.
[14] F. Ricci-Tersenghi, G. Semerjian and L. Zdeborová, *Typology of phase transitions in Bayesian inference problems*, Phys. Rev. E **99** (2019), 042109.
[15] Y. Shmalo, *The Kesten–Stigum bound is sharp for the three-state Potts model on regular trees*, 2026, doi:10.5281/zenodo.24064344.
[16] Y. Shmalo, *The Kesten–Stigum bound is tight for the four-state Potts model on the binary tree*, 2026, doi:10.5281/zenodo.24069889.
[17] A. Sly, *Reconstruction for the Potts model*, Annals of Probability **39** (2011), 1365–1406. Earlier preprint: *Reconstruction of symmetric Potts models*, arXiv:0811.1208.
[18] OpenAI, *The exact reconstruction threshold for the three-state symmetric channel*, manuscript dated 25 September 2026. Manuscript and source files.
[19] OpenAI, *The Reconstruction Threshold for the Ferromagnetic Four-State Potts Model*, manuscript dated 5 October 2026. Manuscript and exact-certificate source.
[20] Y. Shmalo, *Math Brain: public snapshot, code and tests*, 2026, `https://github.com/yspennstate/math-brain-public`.
[21] Y. Shmalo, *Math Brain: shared, auditable memory for multi-agent mathematical research*, October 2026, `https://github.com/yspennstate/math-brain-public/tree/main/papers/math-brain-2026-10-24`.
[22] Y. Shmalo, *Brain Framework*, public software repository, 2026, `https://github.com/yspennstate/brain-framework-public`.

Einstein Institute of Mathematics, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Givat Ram, Jerusalem, Israel

Email address: `yitzchak.shmalo@gmail.com`